

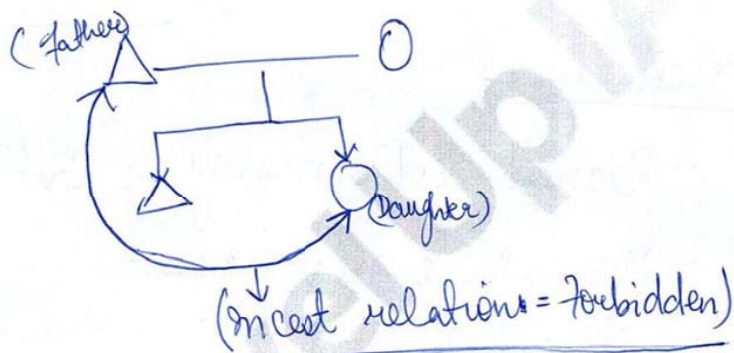


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anything in this Area)

(b) Incest taboo is a pre-social social fact. Comment.

(15 marks)

Incest^{taboo} is a socially forbidden sexual relationship between socially close relatives e.g. Father - Daughter
Mother - Son.



How incest taboo is a ^{pre-social} social fact :-

⇒ Presence of incest across the globe;
even in pre-industrial societies.

This social fact can be better explained by Levi-Strauss "Alliance" theory where in incest taboo is observed in order

to marry outside one's own social group; to strengthen affinal relations and increase group solidarity / Kinship ties among different societies.

Along with Alliance Theory; other theories have discussed origin of Incest taboo:-

① Family disruption theory by Malinowski:-

Since Husband-wife relation is not compatible with father, mother; son & daughter relationship. Hence; in order to avoid chaos in family; Incest taboo was observed.

② Theory given by Freud considers tendency of a son to indulge in Incest but not ~~allowed~~ carried due to fear of

Elders. When son becomes adult, he doesn't allow what wasn't allowed for him, resulting in Incest Taboo.

origin of Incest as a taboo is still debatable since :-

- Primitive man didn't have knowledge of genes to prevent consanguineous inbreeding.
- Prevalence of Incest among Royal Egyptian families.

From above discussion, we can conclude although origin of Incest as a taboo is debatable but it is a positive social fact for greater genetic variability and social solidarity among mankind.